



BIG PITCH IDEA

SENSE BY BARCLAYS

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SENSE BY BARCLAYS

BANKING THAT JUST MAKES SENSE, ESPECIALLY AT GRADUATION

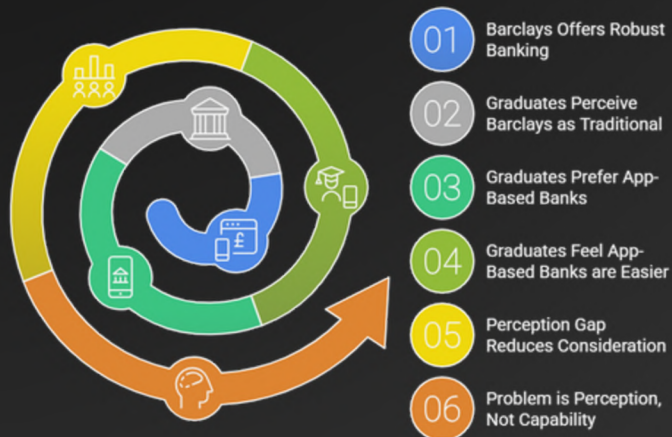
THE IDEA

Despite offering robust online and mobile banking, Barclays is still perceived by graduates as a traditional bank that requires effort and financial confidence.

Graduates increasingly favour app-based banks because they feel simpler and easier to use - even when they offer fewer long-term benefits.

This perception gap reduces consideration for the Barclays Higher Education Account, particularly among graduates who did not previously hold a Barclays student account.

In short, the problem is not capability, but perception.



THE SOLUTION

Sense by Barclays addresses this perception gap through a campaign-led experience that reframes Barclays' existing digital banking as clear, intuitive, and easy to choose at graduation.

Rather than introducing new products, the campaign simplifies how Barclays is communicated and experienced, highlighting everyday relevance, tangible benefits, and ease of use.

This positions Barclays as the logical, modern default for graduates deciding where to bank next. Because it makes sense.



SWOT & PESTEL ANALYSIS BARCLAYS

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STRENGTHS

- **Established Trust**
 - a trusted bank with long understanding reputation.
- **Robust Infrastructure**
 - Online/Mobile Banking are already secure & functional.
- **Clear Value Proposition**
 - "Sense" directly addressing frustration of students facing low effort choices
- **Defined Tangible Benefits**
 - highlights specific practical outcomes.

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WEAKNESSES

- **Negative Brand Perception**

Banks being complex, traditional in graduates POV.
- **High User Effort**

current system requires users to "interpret information," "decide what matters".
- **Transactional Focus**

Current banking is "task-based" rather than intuitive or outcome oriented.

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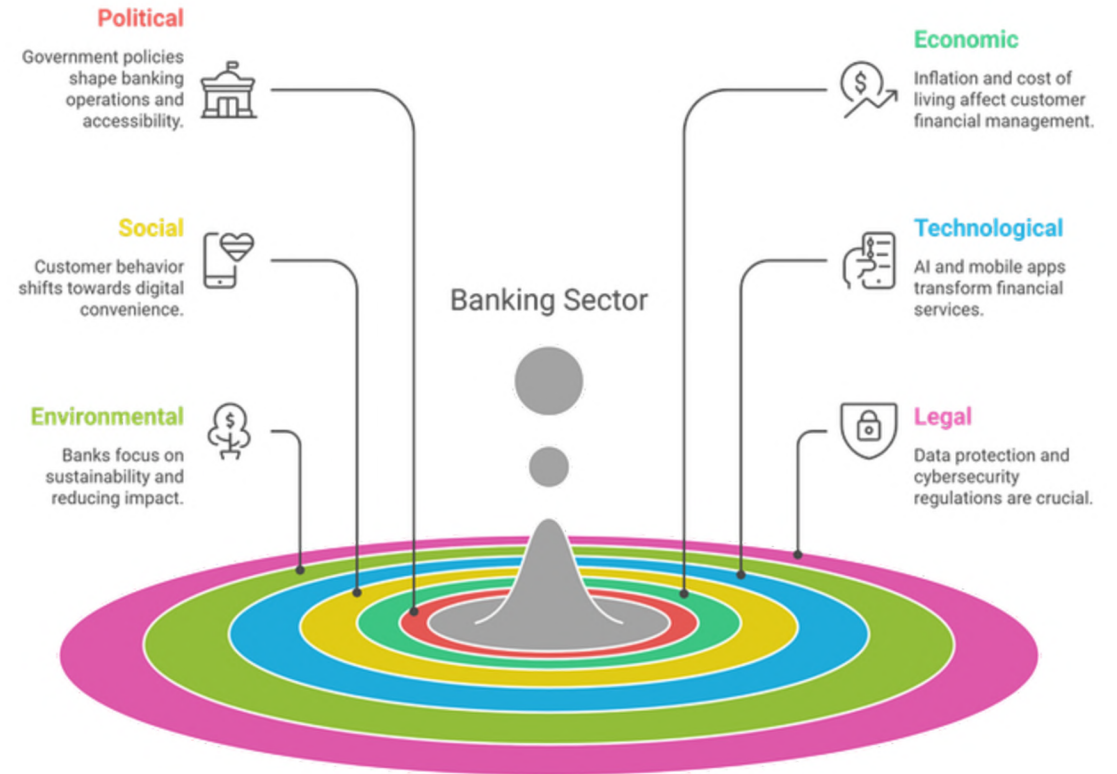
OPPORTUNITIES

- **Perception Gap**
 - Specific opening to win over graduates who value "simpler & easy" app based experiences
- **Communication Simplicity**
 - Practical outcomes benefits to make it sensible choice for graduates
- **Targeting Non Barclays Users**
 - consideration among graduates who did not previously hold a Barclays student account.

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THREATS

- **Agile Competitors**
 - App-based banks are increasingly favored because they are easy to use.
- **Competitor Graduate Accounts**
 - traditional banks are also competing for the same "over 18" UK graduate demographic.
- **Graduate Decision Fatigue**
 - Campaign itself feels effort heavy & may fail to break through mental pressure for students



KEY INSIGHTS OF BARCLAYS

BARCLAYS

Barclays is a big name in the UK. People see it as reliable and trustworthy, almost a classic. But let's be honest, that old-fashioned image doesn't exactly excite students or recent graduates figuring out their finances. Most students have heard of Barclays, that's true—but the tough part is convincing them that the bank gets how young people handle money now. Barclays needs to feel more direct, useful, and genuinely appealing—like somewhere you'd stick around, even after you graduate.

EXTERNAL ANALYSIS

The graduate banking market is shaped by a shift in expectations around convenience, flexibility and low-effort money management. Younger consumers are now used to digital-first experiences and often compare traditional banks with app-based alternatives that feel faster, clearer and easier to navigate. This means Barclays is competing not only on trust, but on usability and perceived effort. Financial pressure is also a major contextual factor for this audience. Graduates are entering a period associated with rent, bills, budgeting and wider financial uncertainty, meaning they are likely to value banks that reduce stress rather than add complexity. As a result, banking brands that appear supportive, intuitive and frictionless are more likely to connect with this segment.

INTERNAL ANALYSIS

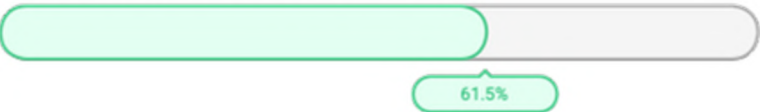
To better understand Barclays' position among graduate audiences, a perception survey was conducted to explore attitudes towards banking behaviour, financial stress, and brand perception. The analysis aimed to identify how graduates currently manage their finances and how traditional banks such as Barclays are perceived compared to newer digital banking services.

The results indicate that Barclays benefits from strong credibility and recognition as an established financial institution. However, the brand is also frequently associated with a more traditional image, which may create distance from younger audiences who prioritise convenience, ease of use, and intuitive digital experiences.

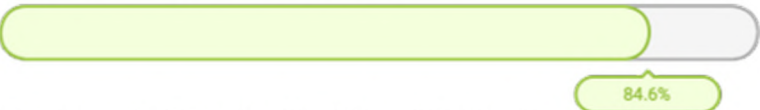
These insights highlight an opportunity for Barclays to reinforce its trustworthiness while presenting itself as a simpler and more supportive financial partner for graduates.

Graduate Banking Survey Key Findings

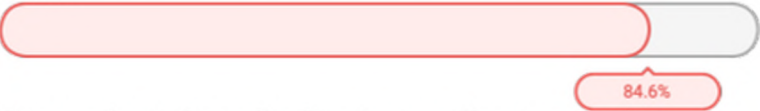
Respondents Using Both Bank Types



Respondents Value Ease of Use



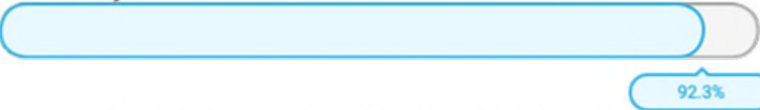
Participants Perceive Traditional Banks Require More Effort



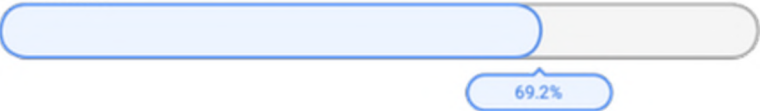
Respondents Describe Barclays as Trustworthy but Traditional



Respondents Rate "Background Banking" Concept Positively



Respondents Likely to Consider Barclays Graduate Account



CHALLENGES FACING BARCLAYS

REASON FOR CLOSURES

Due to the shift and acceleration of the the digital banks such as Monzo, Revolut, etc., the traditional banks are losing their standout.

1. GROWTH OF DIGITAL BANKING

- Increased use of mobile banking apps
- Online account opening and loan applications
- AI-powered chatbots and virtual assistants
- Contactless and mobile payments
- Customers now prefer convenience, 24/7 access, and remote services, reducing the need for physical visits.

2. COST-EFFECTIVENESS

- Physical branches involve high operational costs:
- Rent and property maintenance
- Staff salaries
- Security and utilities
- Digital channels significantly reduce cost per transaction compared to in-branch services.

3. DECLINE IN FOOTFALL

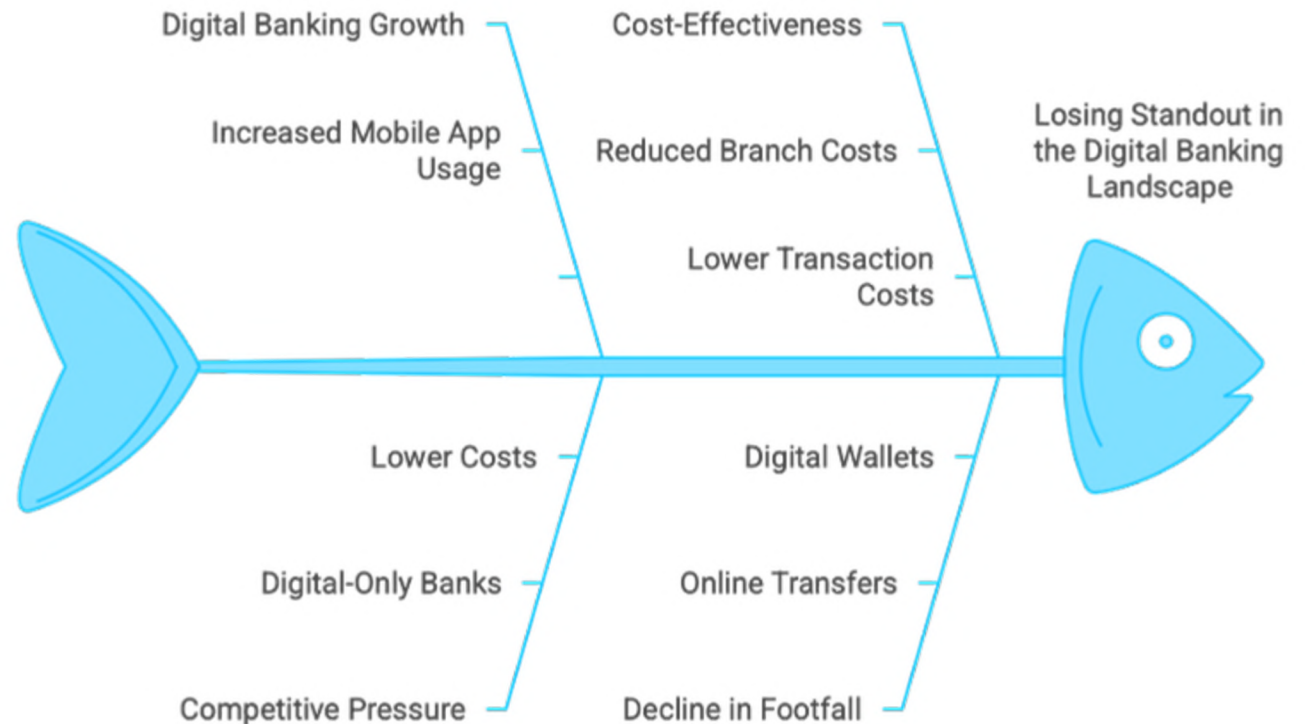
Transaction-based visits (cash withdrawals, balance checks, bill payments) have declined due to:

- Online transfers
- Direct debits
- ATM networks
- Digital wallets
- Many branches report reduced customer visits, making them financially unsustainable.

4. COMPETITIVE PRESSURE

Digital-only challenger banks such as Monzo/Revolut

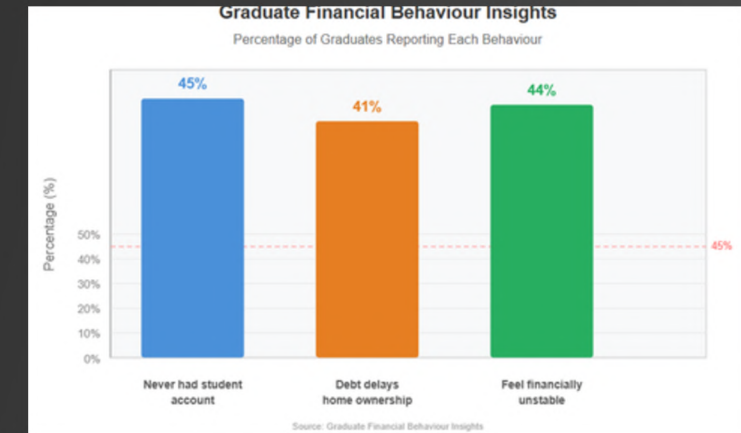
- operate without physical branches, offering lower costs and highly intuitive digital experiences. Traditional banks must adapt to remain competitive



CONSUMER BEHAVIOUR & FINANCIAL REALITY

- ~45% of graduates never opened a student account → indicates low early engagement with traditional banks
- Many rely on fintech first (ease > loyalty)
- Raised on apps like Monzo and Revolut
- Instant notifications
- Real-time balance updates
- Frictionless onboarding (<5 min)
- Average student debt in the UK exceeds £50,000
- Graduates with loans save ~£2,000 less per year for housing deposits
- 41% say debt delays home ownership, and 44% feel financially unstable
- Insight: Graduates are:
- Cash-constrained
- Debt-sensitive
- Focused on short-term financial flexibility

CREDIT-BUILDING TRACKERS WITH GAMIFICATION: MANY GRADUATES DON'T UNDERSTAND HOW TO BUILD A CREDIT SCORE. AN IN-APP "CREDIT VISIBILITY" MODULE COULD SHOW A SIMULATED CREDIT SCORE, EXPLAIN EXACTLY WHICH ACTIONS IMPROVE IT (REGISTERING TO VOTE, PAYING A PHONE CONTRACT ON TIME, USING A SMALL CREDIT CARD AND PAYING IN FULL), AND REWARD PROGRESS MILESTONES WITH SMALL CASH CREDITS. THIS DIRECTLY ADDRESSES A STRESS POINT WHILE CREATING LOCK-IN—THE CREDIT HISTORY IS TIED TO THE ACCOUNT. RESEARCH SHOWS PEOPLE WHO ESTABLISH BANKING RELATIONSHIPS BEFORE AGE 25 ARE THREE TIMES MORE LIKELY TO REMAIN FOR LIFE.



1. AWARENESS VS RELEVANCE: FROM "KNOWN" TO "NEEDED"

THE DATA CONFIRMS THAT AWARENESS IS NOT THE ISSUE. RELEVANCE IS. 44% OF YOUNG UK CONSUMERS BELIEVE NEOBANKS OFFER SIGNIFICANTLY BETTER TOOLS AND SERVICES THAN HIGH-STREET BANKS, AND 27% ALREADY USE THIRD-PARTY MONEY MANAGEMENT TOOLS IF THEIR BANK DOESN'T PROVIDE THEM. GRADUATES AREN'T COMPARING BARCLAYS TO NATWEST—THEY'RE COMPARING IT TO MONZO, STARLING, AND REVOLUT, WHICH EMBED THEMSELVES INTO DAILY LIFE THROUGH INSTANT NOTIFICATIONS, SPENDING CATEGORISATION, OPEN BANKING INTEGRATIONS, AND FRICTIONLESS BILL-SPLITTING. BARCLAYS COULD CO-BRAND DIGITAL FINANCIAL LITERACY MODULES WITH UNIVERSITY CAREERS SERVICES AND STUDENT UNIONS. CONTENT WOULD COVER STUDENT LOAN REPAYMENT MECHANICS, TAX CODES ON FIRST PAYSLEIPS, AND PENSION AUTO-ENROLMENT—PAIN POINTS NO COMPETITOR CURRENTLY ADDRESSES END-TO-END. GRADUATES WHO COMPLETE THE MODULE RECEIVE A £50 CREDIT. THIS BUILDS RELEVANCE THROUGH UTILITY, NOT ADVERTISING.

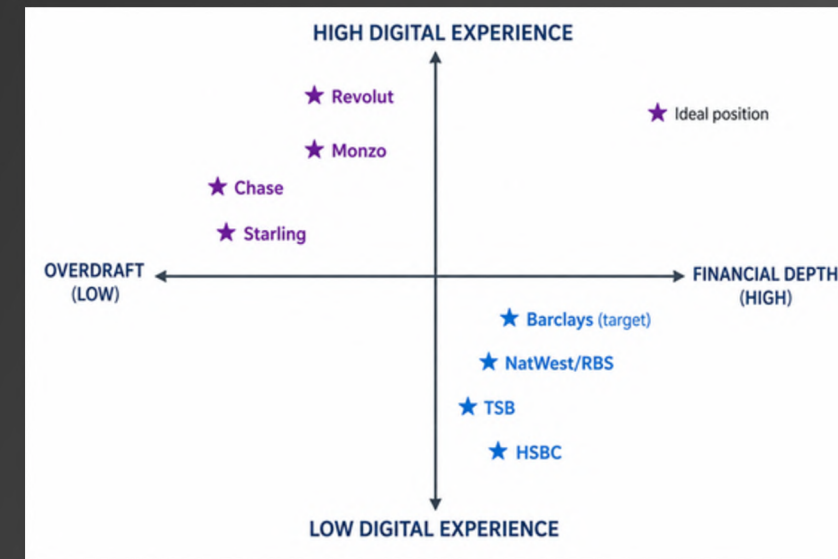
MOVING BEYOND OVERDRAFTS: MAKING FINANCIAL WELLBEING THE PRODUCT

WITH AVERAGE STUDENT DEBT AT £53,000 AND 150,000 GRADUATES NOW OWING OVER £100,000, WHAT KEEPS THIS COHORT AWAKE AT NIGHT IS NOT WHETHER THEY CAN BORROW ANOTHER £1,500—IT'S WHETHER THEY CAN BUILD SAVINGS, IMPROVE THEIR CREDIT PROFILE, AND EVENTUALLY PURCHASE A HOME. 44% OF GRADUATES REPORT FEELING FINANCIALLY UNSTABLE, AND 41% SAY DEBT DELAYS HOME OWNERSHIP.

FINAL POSITIONING INSIGHT: THE "LIFE-PARTNER" BANK

THE DATA SUGGESTS THE OPPORTUNITY GOES FURTHER. GEN Z AND YOUNG MILLENNIALS DON'T JUST WANT A TRANSACTIONAL RELATIONSHIP—THEY WANT A FINANCIAL INSTITUTION THAT DEMONSTRATES IT UNDERSTANDS THEIR SPECIFIC LIFE STAGE AND IS ACTIVELY HELPING THEM PROGRESS. FINTECHS HAVE CAPTURED THE "NOW"—SPLITTING BILLS, TRACKING SPENDING, AVOIDING FOREIGN FEES. WHERE THEY'RE WEAKER IS THE LONG GAME: BUILDING CREDIT, SAVING FOR A HOUSE, REPAYING STUDENT DEBT INTELLIGENTLY.

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45% never had a student account

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE



- HSBC & TSB: higher interest-free overdraft limits — direct alternatives to Barclays grad accounts
- RBS/Natwest: auto-switch from student to graduate; bundles Taste Card & cinema discounts
- Monzo, Chase, Revolut & Starling: leading on mobile UX, push budgeting & near-zero FX fees
- Fintech challengers are attracting graduates who have never banked traditionally
- Monzo, Revolut, Starling Bank
- Traditional Banks
- HSBC: up to £3,000 overdraft
- TSB: up to £2,000 overdraft
- Barclays: up to £1,500 overdraft
- Digital-First Competitors Monzo, Revolut, and Chase dominate among Gen Z
- Insight: Barclays is competing on: Not just products But digital experience + brand perception

- HSBC: UP TO £3,000 (TIERED, FIRST YEAR)
- TSB: UP TO £2,000 (TIERED, THREE YEARS)
- BARCLAYS: UP TO £1,500 (TIERED, FIRST YEAR GRADUATING TO £1,000)
- NATWEST/RBS: UP TO £2,000 (FIRST YEAR, REDUCING)
- MONZO/STARLING/CHASE: NO DEDICATED GRADUATE ACCOUNT; ARRANGED OVERDRAFTS UP TO ~£1,000–£2,000 SUBJECT TO CREDIT CHECKS, OFTEN WITH FEES AFTER A MINIMAL FREE BUFFER (E.G. MONZO OFFERS £50 FEE-FREE, THEN 19%/29% EAR)

HYBRID “OVERDRAFT + FX” PROPOSITION

BARCLAYS CAN TAKE A REAL SWING AT FINTECH BY OFFERING GRADUATES A KILLER ADD-ON: ZERO FEES ON SPENDING ABROAD WITH THEIR DEBIT CARD, PLUS FREE ATM WITHDRAWALS ANYWHERE (UP TO £500 A MONTH). GRADUATES TRAVEL ALL THE TIME, SO IT’S SOMETHING THEY’LL ACTUALLY USE. TO COVER THE COST, DROP THE INTEREST-FREE OVERDRAFT DOWN TO £1,000, BUT THROW IN AN OPTIONAL TRAVEL PASS. THE MESSAGE? YOU CAN TAP INTO YOUR OVERDRAFT IF YOU NEED TO, BUT YOU’LL USE THE TRAVEL PERK EVERY DAY.

TIERED REWARDS FOR HEALTHY FINANCIAL BEHAVIOUR

FORGET CINEMA DISCOUNTS. BUILD A POINTS SYSTEM THAT REWARDS ACTIONS THAT GENUINELY LOWER FINANCIAL STRESS—LIKE HITTING SAVINGS GOALS, PAYING BILLS ON TIME, AND COMPLETING BUDGETING MODULES. GRADUATES CAN TURN THESE POINTS INTO CASHBACK, WAIVED MORTGAGE FEES LATER, OR EVEN A “DEPOSIT BOOST” FOR THEIR FIRST HOME. THAT WAY, BARCLAYS ISN’T JUST ANOTHER BANK; IT BECOMES THEIR FINANCIAL COACH.

1. “GRADUATE FINANCIAL HEALTH SCORE” – IN-APP GAMIFICATION

GO BEYOND CREDIT SCORES. CREATE A UNIQUE FINANCIAL STABILITY SCORE—TRACKING INCOME REGULARITY, SAVINGS HABITS, WASTED SUBSCRIPTIONS, AND CREDIT USE. SHOW UPDATES EVERY WEEK, TOSS IN PRACTICAL TIPS, AND LET GRADUATES SHARE ANONYMIZED LEADERBOARDS AND CHALLENGES WITH FRIENDS. FINTECHS THRIVE ON THIS KIND OF ENGAGEMENT. BARCLAYS CAN GET IN THE LOOP TOO.

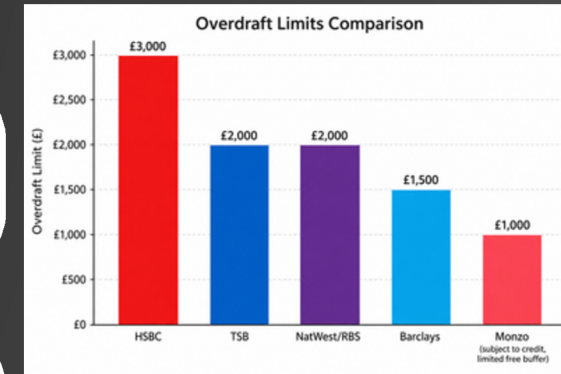
PARTNERSHIP WITH GRADUATE EMPLOYERS – EMBEDDED BANKING

BIG EMPLOYERS ALREADY PROCESS LOADS OF GRADUATE JOINERS. STRIKE UP A CORPORATE PARTNERSHIP SO BARCLAYS BECOMES THE BANK THEY RECOMMEND TO NEW STARTERS. OFFER AN EXCLUSIVE “FIRST YEAR SALARY ADVANCE”—UP TO A MONTH’S SALARY, INTEREST-FREE, REPAID OVER THREE MONTHS—TO MAKE DEPOSIT AND RELOCATION EXPENSES LESS PAINFUL. IT SOLVES A REAL PROBLEM AND SECURES REGULAR PAYROLL DEPOSITS.

AUTO-SWITCH WITH A “SWITCH & SCORE” CREDIT BUILDER

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- BRING BARCLAYS’ STRENGTHS—MORTGAGE, SAVINGS, WEALTH MANAGEMENT—INTO ONE SOLID, MODERN GRADUATE APP. ROLL OUT A FULL FINTECH FEATURE LINEUP WITHIN A YEAR (SUBSCRIPTION MANAGEMENT, SPENDING INSIGHTS, FEE-FREE CURRENCY EXCHANGE, INSTANT NOTIFICATIONS, AND MONEY POTS). THEN, HIGHLIGHT THAT 330 YEARS OF STABILITY, WHICH MAKES A DIFFERENCE WHEN GRADUATES START THINKING BEYOND DAY-TO-DAY SPENDING AND FOCUS ON SAVING FOR A HOUSE OR THEIR FINANCIAL FUTURE.



6+ DIRECT COMPETITORS TARGETING GRADUATES

OPPORTUNITIES

1. Strong brand trust serves as a real engine for acquiring new customers. With a long history and a reputation that's deeply ingrained in the public's mind, Barclays stands out as a bank graduates feel they can trust. That's no small thing. People looking to open their first "grown-up" account want stability, especially when their financial lives are just beginning. This trust isn't just comforting it translates into real action, making graduates who might otherwise try a trendy fintech more likely to sign up with Barclays and even use it as their main bank.

2. There's a whole group of graduates out there slipping through the cracks: those who never bothered with a student account. Traditional recruitment through university partnerships doesn't reach them. That's a big chunk of untapped potential a segment Barclays can actively pursue with offers tailored specifically for recent grads. It's a chance to build relationships that competitors miss because they're too focused on capturing students earlier.



3. Blue Rewards stands out. It's not just another rewards program it hands customers tangible benefits every month, like cashback and exclusive perks. This isn't about just letting an account sit dormant. Blue Rewards encourages people to use their Barclays account for everyday purchases, deepening engagement and making Barclays part of daily routines.

4. Let's face it: Barclays has to step up its digital experience. The mobile app and overall digital journey don't quite stack up against leaders like Monzo and Starling Bank. Users want a smooth, intuitive interface, instant spending insights, and a streamlined, modern feel. Without significant upgrades, new grads might look elsewhere, swayed by competitors who make managing money truly effortless.

5. Graduate accounts used to compete primarily on who offered the biggest overdraft. That's changing. Overdraft limits just aren't the differentiator they once were. Today's graduates want more lifestyle perks, savings tools, and resources that support their financial wellbeing. By expanding beyond overdrafts, Barclays can offer broader value and stand apart from others that haven't adapted.

6. There's an opportunity for Barclays to grow beyond the "transactional bank" label. Graduates need more than a place to keep their money; they need a partner on their financial journey. If Barclays steps up with tools for budgeting, savings, credit building, and future planning, it can support graduates at every stage and strengthen lasting loyalty in the process.

STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY

Awareness vs Relevance

Everybody knows Barclays. That's not their problem. The real question is: does anyone actually care about it? For most grads, Barclays just doesn't feel like a bank they'd use in their daily lives. Monzo and Starling look slick, digital, and way more relevant than they fit into how people live now.

Addressing Real Graduate Pain Points

Graduates are dealing with serious stuff: student loans, trying to save, managing tight budgets. Barclays can really set itself apart if it offers practical help: tools, advice, and support that actually make financial decisions easier. Nobody wants more generic banking products.

Moving Beyond Overdrafts

Big overdrafts might've been a draw in the past, but graduates aren't impressed anymore. They want smarter tools, rewards that make sense, and features that actually help lower their stress about money. It's time to ditch credit buffers as the main perk and focus on genuine financial wellbeing.

Competing with Fintech Experience

Fintechs changed the game. Monzo and Starling make banking feel fast, easy, and personal. If Barclays wants in, its digital experience has to level up. Graduates expect a banking app that's intuitive and modern, not something outdated or clunky.

Final Positioning Insight

If Barclays adapts to what grads expect, it can shake off the "legacy bank" label. It could actually become a modern, relevant financial partner one that goes head-to-head with the best digital banks out there.



TARGET: 10,000 NEW CUSTOMERS IN 6 MONTHS

DIGITAL & LOYALTY MARKETING STRATEGIES

Graduate audiences expect banking to be simple, fast, and personalised. However, traditional banks are often perceived as complex and less intuitive compared to digital-first competitors.

Research shows that **71% of customers expect personalised experiences**, while **76% feel frustrated when these are not delivered** (Tapix, 2024). Furthermore, as shown in the figure, banks that adopt hyper-personalisation achieve measurable results, including +30% higher engagement, +15% increased customer satisfaction, and +15% revenue growth (Tapix, 2024).

This highlights a shift in the banking sector, where success is no longer defined by acquisition alone, but by the ability to create continuous, personalised engagement.

Therefore, this strategy focuses on:

- Personalisation: making banking feel simple and relevant
- Rewards: encouraging switching and continued usage
- Engagement: building long-term habits and loyalty



Impact of hyper-personalisation in banking (Tapix, 2024)

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR BARCLAYS

To compete with digital-first banks, Barclays must move beyond traditional banking features and deliver a more personalised, intuitive experience.

By combining real-time insights with reward-driven engagement, Barclays can position itself as a simple, relevant, and everyday financial partner for graduates.

BRINGING SENSE TO LIFE



Sense Insights

Uses spending data to identify patterns and recommend smarter financial decisions.



Sense Alerts

Proactively notifies users of risks or opportunities (e.g. overspending, saving potential).



Sense Feed

Predicts user needs and delivers personalised recommendations at the right moment.

THE SHIFT TO PROACTIVE BANKING

The future of banking is shifting from reactive services to proactive, data-driven experiences.

Predictive analytics enables banks to analyse user behaviour and anticipate future needs, allowing them to deliver personalised insights, timely recommendations, and proactive support (Robosoft, 2024)

WHY THIS MATTERS TO GRADUATES

Graduates often face financial uncertainty and need simple, clear guidance when managing their money for the first time.

By providing real-time insights and proactive support, “Sense” reduces complexity and helps users make confident financial decisions.

This creates a more intuitive, low-effort banking experience, aligning with the expectations of digital-first users.

LOYALTY & REWARDS

To support long-term engagement, the campaign uses a **behaviour-driven loyalty strategy** that rewards not just sign-ups, but consistent and meaningful usage.

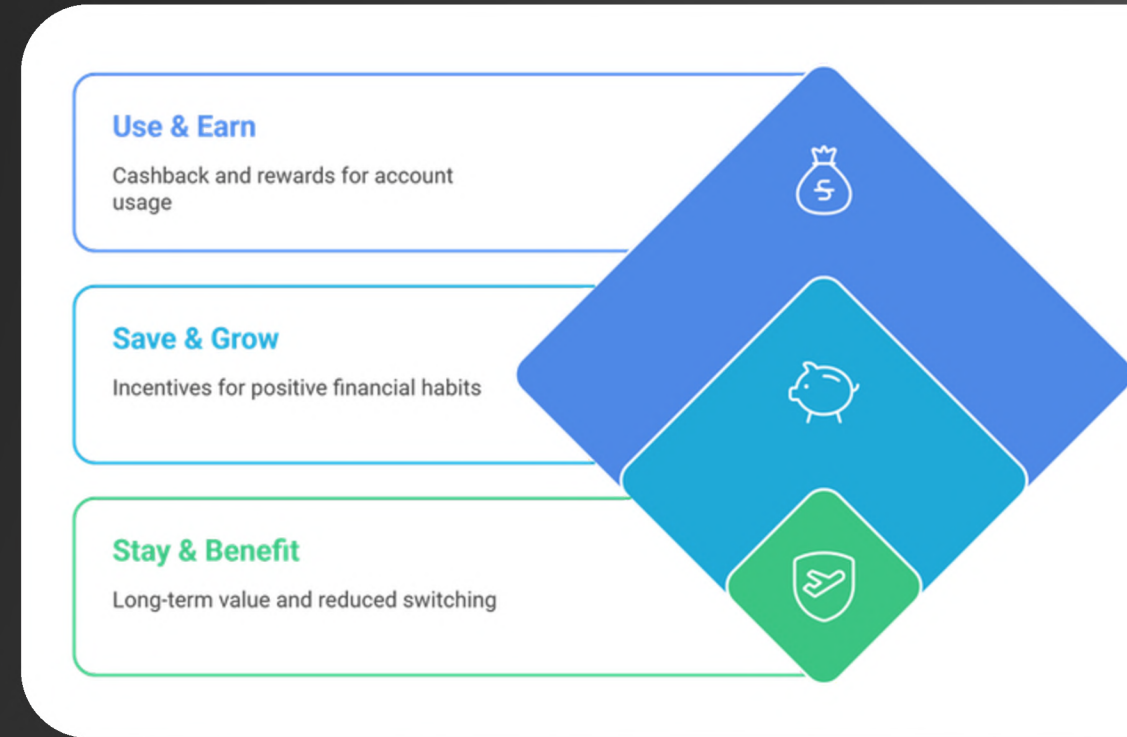
Rather than offering generic incentives, rewards are designed to **reinforce positive financial habits** and encourage graduates to use Barclays as their primary account.

Research suggests that loyalty in banking is shifting away from one-time incentives towards continuous engagement and personalised value, which are key to building long-term customer relationships (UK Finance, 2024).

POWERED BY BLUE REWARDS

This strategy builds on Barclays' existing Blue Rewards programme, enhancing its value through behaviour-based incentives and personalised benefits.

By integrating rewards with everyday banking activities, Barclays strengthens engagement while maintaining a familiar and trusted system.



HOW THIS DRIVES BEHAVIOUR

By rewarding everyday financial actions, the strategy builds repeated usage and reinforces positive habits, increasing the likelihood that graduates adopt Barclays as their primary account and remain engaged long-term.

USER JOURNEY

1. Awareness

Graduates discover Sense by Barclays through social media, influencers, and campus promotions.

2. Consideration

They engage with simple, relatable content showing how Barclays makes banking easier (budgeting, salary, rent).

3. Conversion

Users open a Barclays Graduate Account via a fast, digital onboarding experience.

4. Experience

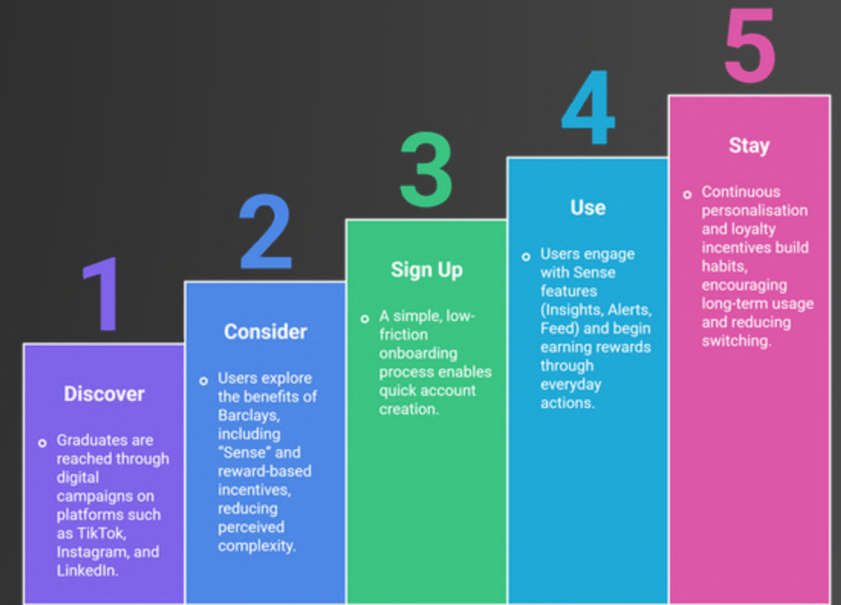
They start using features like spending insights, rewards, and real-time notifications.

5. Engagement

Personalised insights + Blue Rewards encourage daily usage.

6. Loyalty

Users adopt Barclays as their primary bank and continue long-term.



CONNECTING DISCOVERY TO USAGE, REDUCING EFFORT AND POSITIONING BARCLAYS AS THE SIMPLEST CHOICE FOR GRADUATES.



TURNING AWARENESS INTO USAGE THROUGH SIMPLICITY AND PERSONALISATION.

CHANNELS & TOUCHPOINTS (WHERE IT HAPPENS)

Stage	Channels	Touchpoints
Awareness	Instagram, TikTok, YouTube	Short videos, ads, influencer content
Consideration	LinkedIn, YouTube, Website	Explainers, success stories
Conversion	Barclays App / Website	Account signup, onboarding
Experience	Mobile App	Spending insights, notifications
Engagement	Email, App notifications	Rewards, personalised tips
Loyalty	Blue Rewards, Community	Offers, referrals, long-term usage

“A DIGITAL-FIRST ECOSYSTEM SUPPORTED BY PHYSICAL AND HUMAN TOUCHPOINTS.”

MEASUREMENT & SUCCESS

1. Awareness Metrics

Reach & impressions
Video views
Social engagement rate

2. Consideration Metrics

Click-through rate (CTR)
Website visits
Time spent on content

3. Conversion Metrics

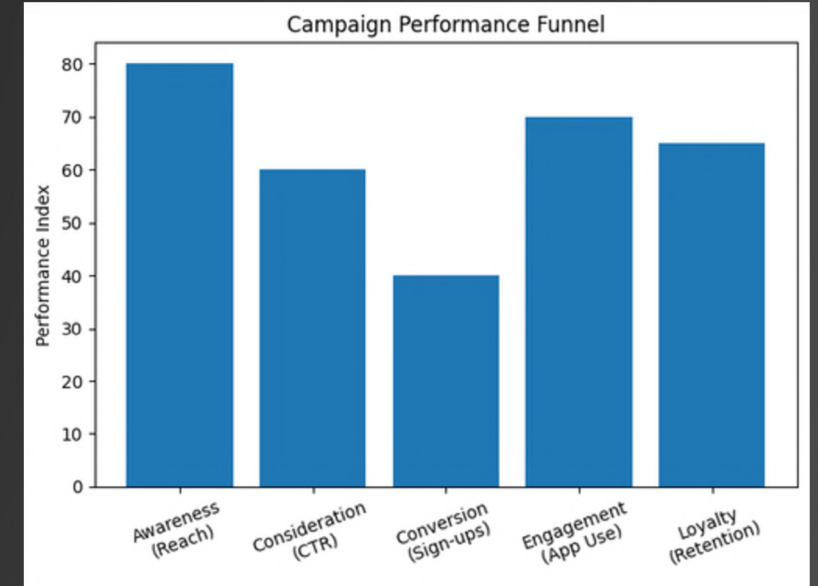
Number of account sign-ups
Conversion rate
Cost per acquisition (CPA)

4. Engagement Metrics

App usage frequency
Feature usage (budgeting tools)
Email open rates

5. Loyalty Metrics

Retention rate
Active users (monthly)
Blue Rewards participation



This shows how we measure campaign success across each stage of the funnel. Starting from awareness, we track reach and engagement, followed by consideration through click through and content interaction. Conversion is measured by the number of account sign ups, while engagement focuses on how actively users interact with the app's features. Finally, loyalty is evaluated through retention and continued usage. The bar chart represents these key performance indicators, showing how each stage contributes to turning awareness into long-term customer relationships.

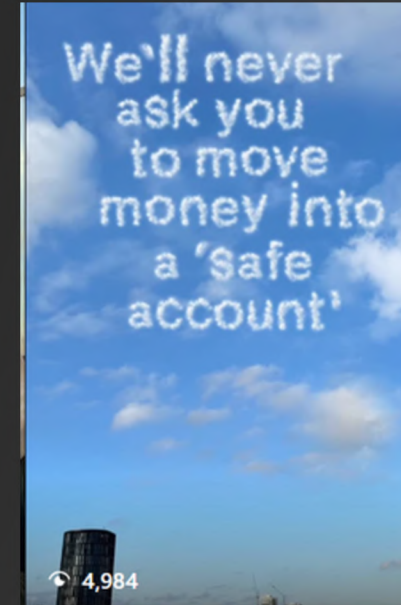
CRAFTING A WINNING CAMPAIGN

THE BIG IDEA — SENSE BY BARCLAYS

Sense by Barclays gets straight to the point: banking doesn't have to be a maze, even if you just graduated. Most grads glance at the finance world and instantly feel overwhelmed by jargon and endless steps. Barclays decided enough is enough. This campaign doesn't try to dazzle with fancy new products. Instead, it puts clarity and simplicity front and center. Barclays wants you to see how digital banking can actually make life easier, especially when you're fresh out of university and managing your own money for the first time.

Everything about the campaign is no-fuss-real, everyday perks, tools that actually make sense, and messaging that doesn't waste your time. Forget the hype and gimmicks. It's about helping new grads take control of their money without getting a headache.

At the end of the day, Barclays positions itself as the straightforward, smart choice for anyone just getting started. The message's pretty hard to miss: "Sense by Barclays – Because it makes sense." And really, that's all there is to it.



Sense by Barclays: Simplifying Banking for Grads

Clarity and Simplicity

Focuses on easy-to-understand banking

No-Fuss Approach

Avoids complex jargon and gimmicks

Everyday Perks

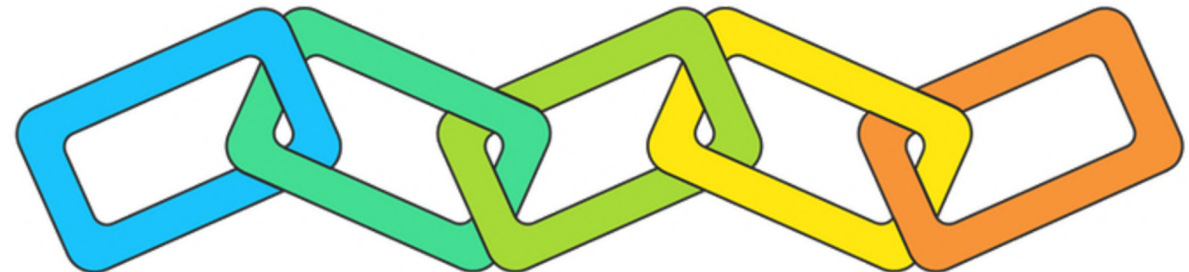
Offers practical benefits for new grads

Smart Choice

Positions Barclays as the intelligent option

Clear Messaging

Conveys the core message effectively



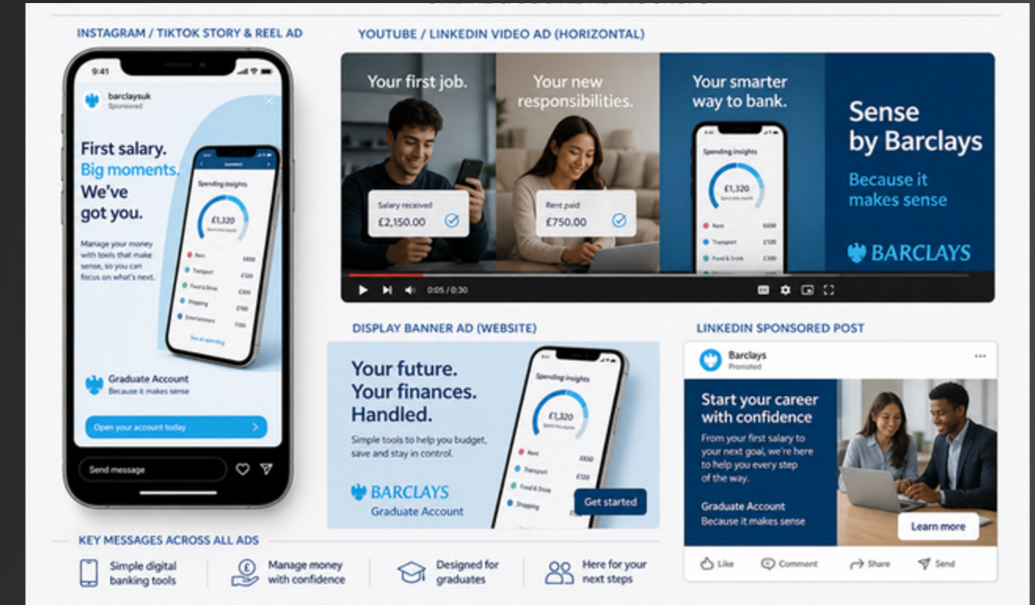
ONLINE & SOCIAL ADS

Short-form digital videos and interactive content will showcase how Barclays supports graduates in their everyday financial lives.

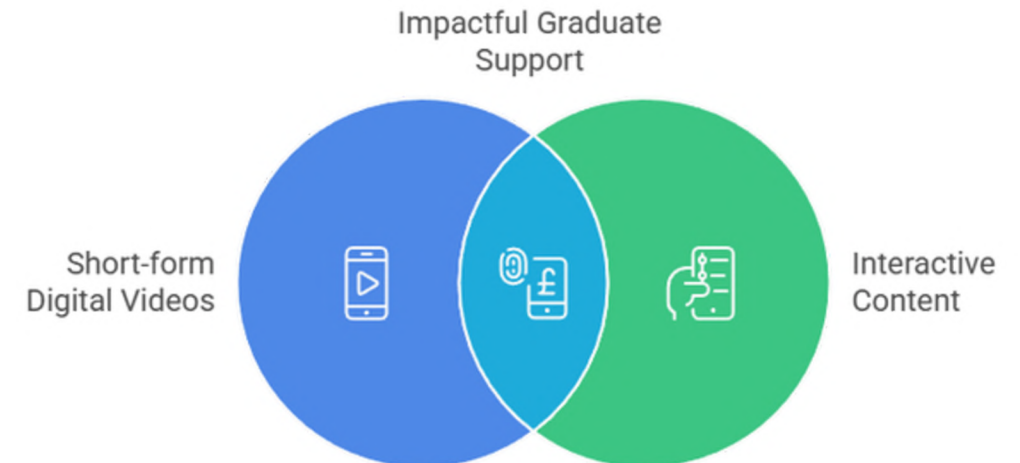
Examples include:

- “Life After Graduation” videos showing graduates managing their first salary, rent, and expenses using the Barclays app.
- Short explainers highlighting simple banking tools such as spending insights and budgeting features.
- Graduate success stories featuring individuals who started their careers through the Barclays Graduate Scheme.

These videos will be distributed across platforms commonly used by students and young professionals such as LinkedIn, Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube.



Maximizing Graduate Engagement Through Digital Content



UNIVERSITY & CAMPUS PROMOTIONS

Digital signage, posters, and informational leaflets placed in university career centres will guide students toward the Barclays Graduate Scheme.

These materials will:

- Promote the benefits of the graduate programme
- Direct students to the Barclays careers website
- Encourage attendance at digital career events or webinars

This ensures the campaign reaches students during the key decision period before graduation.

INFLUENCER & UGC (USER- GENERATED CONTENT)

The campaign will collaborate with student influencers, graduate career creators, and current Barclays graduates.

Content may include:

- “My First Year at Barclays” stories
- Application advice from Barclays graduate employees
- Social media posts where graduates share their journey into the banking industry

This peer-to-peer storytelling helps make the scheme feel authentic, achievable, and relatable.

CHANNEL SELECTION

Digital signage, posters, and informational leaflets placed in university career centres will guide students to open their accounts with Barclays Graduate Scheme.

These materials will:

- Promote the benefits of the graduate programme
- Direct students to the Barclays careers website
- Encourage attendance at digital career events or webinars

The Idea is to catch students right when they are making big decisions about what comes after graduation

OFFLINE CHANNELS

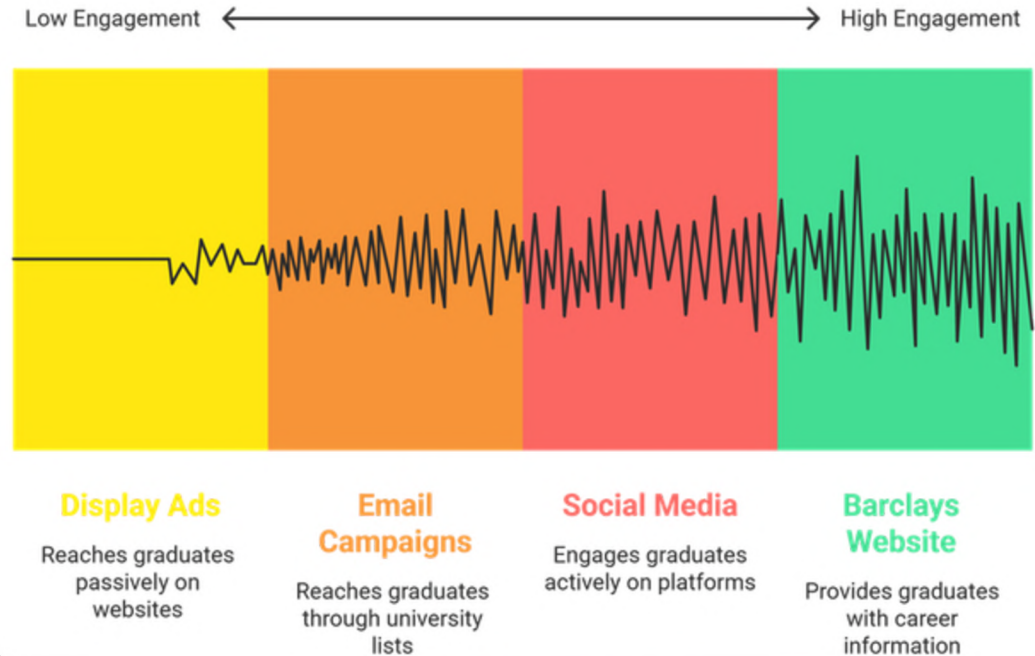
Although the campaign is digital-first, physical touchpoints can reinforce awareness.

Examples include:

- Pamphlets, newspaper.
- Posters and flyers buses as banner, buildings etc for promotion.
- Recommendations through university career advisors
- Some promotion flyers on streets etc.

These offline elements help support the digital campaign and increase visibility among students.

Digital channels ranked by graduate engagement level







EXPERIMENTAL: NETWORKING EVENTS

As part of the Barclays Graduate Scheme campaign, networking promotions focus on creating direct, meaningful connections between graduates and the brand.

Through career networking events, virtual meetups, and alumni-led sessions, students can interact with current Barclays graduates, recruiters, and industry professionals. These sessions provide insights into career paths, application tips, and real experiences within Barclays.

The aim is to make the brand feel accessible, supportive, and human, helping graduates build confidence while reinforcing Barclays as a trusted and logical career choice — because it makes sense.

Sense by Barclays
WEBINAR
Start your future with purpose.
Discover the Barclays Graduate Scheme.
Wednesday 22 May 2024
12:00 – 1:00 PM
Online event
[Register now](#)
barclays.com/graduates
Because it makes sense. **BARCLAYS**

Sense by Barclays
Graduate Career Event
Real conversations. Real opportunities.
Barclays London Office
Thursday 6 June 2024
Networking | Panels | Workshops
[Secure your spot](#)
barclays.com/graduates
Because it makes sense.

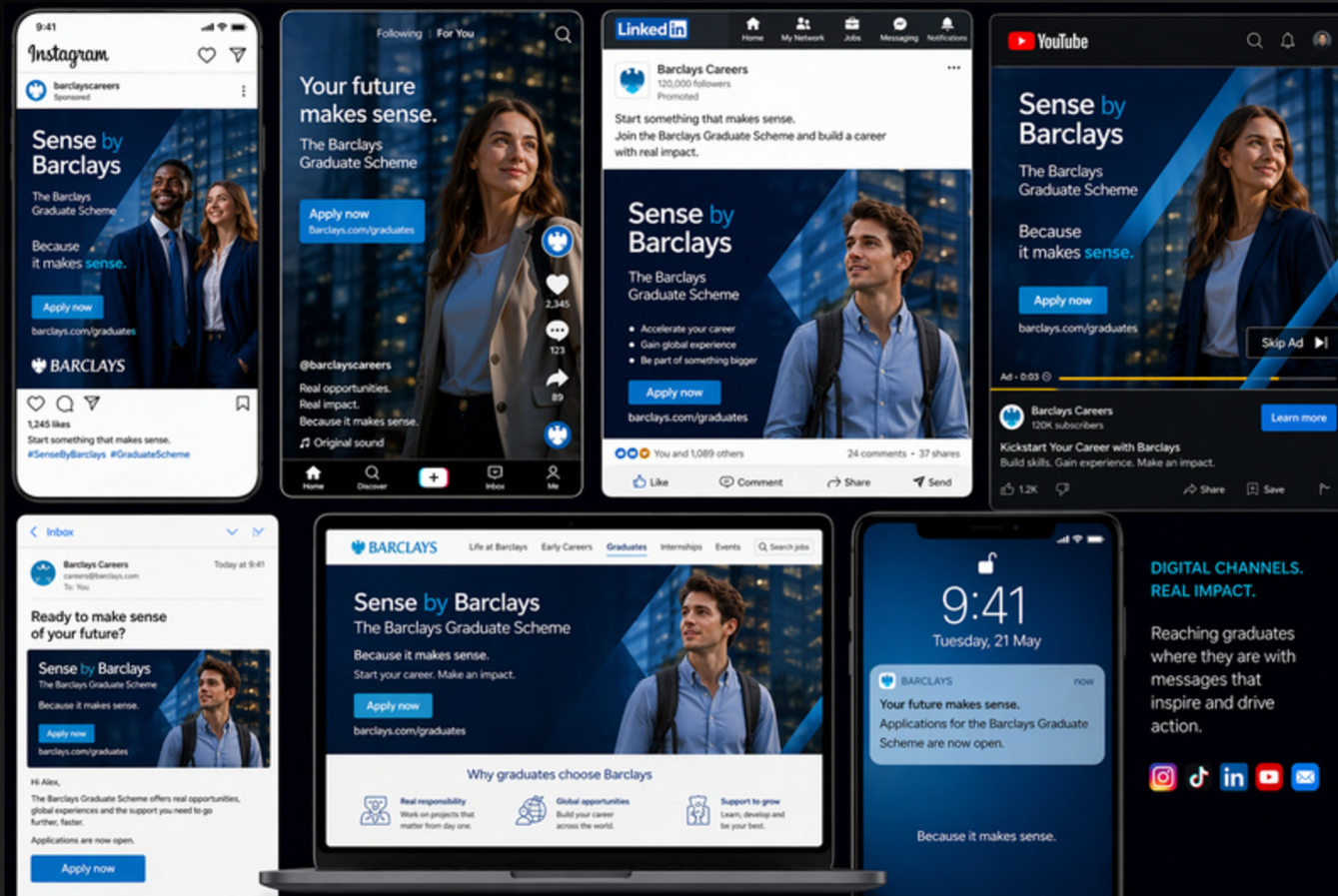
Sense by Barclays
VIRTUAL INSIGHT SERIES
Explore careers. Expand possibilities.
Join our interactive webinars with Barclays professionals.
Investment Banking | Technology | Risk | Marketing
Every Tuesday in May
5:00 – 6:00 PM (BST)
[Sign up today](#)
barclays.com/graduates
Because it makes sense. **BARCLAYS**

Sense by Barclays
Networking that opens doors.
Connect with graduates, recruiters and business leaders.
Barclays London Office
Wednesday 29 May 2024
6:00 – 8:00 PM
[Join the network](#)
barclays.com/graduates
Because it makes sense.

Sense by Barclays
CAREER PATHS SEMINAR
Where can a degree take you?
Explore roles. Learn from experts. Shape your career.
Friday 31 May 2024
1:00 – 2:30 PM
Online event
[Register now](#)
barclays.com/graduates
Because it makes sense.
Sense by Barclays
The Barclays Graduate Scheme

Sense by Barclays
LIVE Q&A SESSION
Your questions. Our graduates.
Get honest answers about the Barclays Graduate Scheme.
Thursday 23 May 2024
12:30 – 1:15 PM
Online event
[Ask your questions](#)
barclays.com/graduates
Because it makes sense. **BARCLAYS**

DIGITAL CHANNELS



The Barclays Graduate Scheme campaign uses a digital-first approach to reach graduates where they spend most of their time. Platforms such as LinkedIn, Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube deliver short-form videos, success stories, and interactive content that simplify Barclays' message and highlight real career opportunities.

Targeted email campaigns, app notifications, and display ads ensure timely communication, especially during key decision periods like final year and post-graduation. Each touchpoint reinforces the campaign message “Because it makes sense,” positioning Barclays as a clear, modern, and easy career choice for graduates.

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